

Eightfold.ai

Buyer's Journey by Theme

Five themes · Four stages · Customer Lens · Eightfold Lens

How to use this document

This framework represents the demand generation journey — the stages through which we engage and nurture prospective buyers from initial Inquiry through to Sales Qualified Lead (SQL) handoff to sales. It does not cover the sales cycle that follows.

Each table covers one theme across four buyer's journey stages.

- **The Stage Question** defines what we are answering for the buyer at that point in the journey.
- **The Customer Lens** captures the prospect's actual question in their language.
- **The Eightfold Lens** is our differentiated answer — grounded in the messaging hierarchy, brand voice, and approved language from the Eightfold messaging guide.

Stage definitions:

- **Awareness** — The buyer is naming the problem; they are not yet actively looking for solutions. Content at this stage educates them on the challenge and frames the opportunity.
- **Discovery** — The buyer is actively learning what AI-powered talent intelligence is and how it differs from what they already have. Content explains the “what” and “how.”
- **Consideration** — The buyer is evaluating vendors and wants evidence, benchmarks, and direct comparisons. Content provides proof and differentiates.
- **Buy** — The buyer is ready to validate fit for their specific context. Content enables a customized proof-of-concept or pilot.

Products are drawn from Eightfold's layered stack — Platform, Applications, Agents, and TalentForge. TalentForge is a horizontal build layer available across all themes. Each theme lists its relevant products in the intro section above the table.

Persona signals are embedded in the messaging rather than as a separate structural layer. Theme 5 (Public Sector) is specific to government and public-sector buyers.

Theme 1: Agentic Hiring

Primary persona: TA Leader / Recruiter | Secondary: CHRO (org outcomes), CFO / CIO (Consideration + Buy)

About this theme

This theme is for organizations struggling with hiring volume, speed, and quality at scale. It covers how Eightfold's AI Interviewer replaces manual screening bottlenecks with autonomous, bias-audited candidate evaluation — so recruiters stop processing volume and start leading relationships. Primary audience: TA Leaders and Recruiters; secondary: CHROs, CFOs, and CIOs evaluating cost and compliance impact.

Products

- AI Interviewer** — autonomous, bias-audited candidate evaluation at any scale
- AI Interview Companion** — AI-assisted structured evaluation for human-led interviews; the on-ramp before full autonomous deployment
- Candidate Agent** — end-to-end candidate journey across SMS, WhatsApp, web, and voice — no resume required
- Talent Acquisition** — skills-based pipeline intelligence and ATS integration layer
- TalentForge** — custom hiring workflows, role-specific evaluation frameworks, and bespoke candidate experiences built on Eightfold's intelligence foundation

	AWARENESS	DISCOVERY	CONSIDERATION	BUY
Stage Question	<i>The way we hire, develop, and deploy talent isn't keeping pace with the business — and I don't yet have a clear picture of why or what to do about it.</i>	<i>What does AI-powered talent intelligence actually do — and how is it fundamentally different from the HCM system we already have?</i>	<i>We understand the category. Now we need to know: does the evidence hold up — what do organizations like ours actually achieve, and how does Eightfold compare to what we already have?</i>	<i>We're ready to go deeper. We want to see Eightfold work for our specific situation before we move forward.</i>
Customer Lens <i>The question the prospect has</i>	Hiring is taking too long, costing too much, and still producing inconsistent outcomes. The volume is overwhelming my team. Manual processes mean we're slow, biased by bandwidth, and losing candidates to faster competitors. Who is actually solving this at enterprise scale?	What does agentic AI actually do in a hiring workflow — and how is it different from the ATS or scheduling tools we already have? What does bias-free, skills-based evaluation look like in practice, and what does the candidate experience feel like?	What outcomes have organizations like ours actually achieved — specifically time-to-fill, recruiter productivity, and candidate experience? And how does Eightfold compare to HireVue or Paradox?	We've done the research. We want to see the AI Interviewer work in our actual context — our ATS, our hiring volume, our role types — before we take the next step.
Eightfold Lens <i>Our differentiated answer</i>	The hiring model wasn't built for this. It was built when humans were the only option. Every recruiter is a bottleneck. Every candidate waits. The AI Interviewer evaluates one or one million with identical rigor and zero bias — so your team stops processing volume and starts leading relationships. Every candidate gets the nine o'clock interview.	The instinct to ask "will this work?" is right. Most organizations considering an AI Interviewer have the same three concerns: candidate experience, legal exposure, and whether an algorithm can fairly evaluate a person. Here is what the evidence shows: candidates who complete an AI interview consistently rate the experience as fair, transparent, and less stressful than a phone screen.	42-day hiring cycle reduced to 5 days. 5x recruiter productivity. STMicroelectronics saved 160+ recruiter hours in 2 months. The AI Interviewer evaluates on capabilities and trajectory — not keyword matches — so shortlists arrive pre-assessed, not pre-sorted. Assessment-only tools test today's capabilities. Scheduling tools move faster. Eightfold brings talent intelligence to the evaluation — and	Request a pilot designed for your hiring environment — or try the AI Interviewer yourself on our website before we go further. We'll show the AI Interviewer evaluate candidates against your specific role requirements, integrated with your ATS, with bias audit results mapped to your workforce context. See what your recruiters get back — and what your candidates experience.

	AWARENESS	DISCOVERY	CONSIDERATION	BUY
		Bias is reduced — not introduced — because evaluation is grounded in capabilities and trajectory, not the signals human interviewers unconsciously weight. Eightfold's compliance design is built for EEOC, GDPR, the EU AI Act, and US state-level AI hiring laws — not retrofitted after the fact. The AI Interviewer doesn't schedule or track — it evaluates. And for organizations ready to go further, the 360 Interview collapses screening, functional, coding, and language assessments into a single agent-orchestrated conversation.	connects to your ATS without replacing it.	

Theme 2: Employee Growth & Internal Mobility

Primary persona: CHRO / HR Leader | Secondary: Line Managers, HRBPs (Consideration), COO / CFO (Buy)

About this theme

This theme is for organizations losing talent externally that could be developed and retained internally. It covers how Eightfold surfaces the capabilities, potential, and career trajectories of existing employees — turning a hidden workforce into a talent advantage.

Two distinct buyer camps engage with this theme. C-level buyers are on offense: they want to grow the business without growing headcount by redeploying the talent they already have. HR leaders and CHROs are on defense: they want to reduce regrettable attrition, give employees visible career paths, and improve the experience that keeps people from leaving. Both camps ultimately fund the same solution — but the proof points that resonate with each are different.

Products

Talent Management — real-time capability detection, career trajectory modeling, and retention intelligence across the workforce

Career Coach Agent — conversational AI that gives every employee a personalized development experience and visible internal growth paths

Career Hub — employee-facing surface for discovering internal opportunities matched to capabilities and aspirations

TalentForge — custom career development apps, capability portals, and internal mobility surfaces on Eightfold's intelligence foundation

	AWARENESS	DISCOVERY	CONSIDERATION	BUY
Stage Question	<i>The way we hire, develop, and deploy talent isn't keeping pace with the business — and I don't yet have a clear picture of why or what to do about it.</i>	<i>What does AI-powered talent intelligence actually do — and how is it fundamentally different from the HCM system we already have?</i>	<i>We understand the category. Now we need to know: does the evidence hold up — what do organizations like ours actually achieve, and how does Eightfold compare to what we already have?</i>	<i>We're ready to go deeper. We want to see Eightfold work for our specific situation before we move forward.</i>
Customer Lens <i>The question the prospect has</i>	Regrettable attrition is accelerating — our best people are leaving for growth they could have gotten internally, if we could have seen it. We're filling roles externally while capable employees sit on our payroll, invisible to managers and recruiters alike. Who can help us turn our existing workforce into a talent advantage?	What does a skills-based approach actually require — and how does AI make it actionable rather than aspirational? How do we build career pathing and internal mobility that employees and managers actually use?	What adoption and retention outcomes have organizations achieved — and how does the employee experience compare to what our HCM's career planning features already provide? What can we realistically show our CFO and COO?	We want to understand what Eightfold reveals about our workforce — our capability gaps, our hidden potential, our mobility opportunities — before we commit to anything.
Eightfold Lens <i>Our differentiated answer</i>	The workforce advantage your business needs is already employed — it's just invisible to systems that only see job titles and resumes. Talent Intelligence reads adjacent capabilities and forecasts where people can go, surfacing the internal candidate your ATS never would have found. Grow the business without growing the org chart.	Skills-based organizations outperform — but most programs fail because the data is incomplete and the system can't act on it. The Eightfold platform continuously detects capabilities, potential, and career trajectory signals in real time, surfacing them to managers, HRBPs, and employees through Career Hub. Fortive filled 45% of roles internally. Vodafone achieved +86 NPS. The	Coca-Cola Europacific Partners achieved 90% adoption. BMS reduced time-to-fill by 21% through internal mobility. Fortive filled 45% of roles internally. The Career Coach Agent drives these results by giving every employee a personalized, conversational development experience — not a portal they visit once a year, not a form their HRBP fills out for them.	Request a workforce capabilities assessment. We'll show you what Eightfold's intelligence detects in your existing data — capabilities your HCM has never surfaced, mobility paths your employees don't know exist, and retention risks you can act on before someone hands in their notice. The platform connects to your HCM. The skills taxonomy builds from your data, not from scratch.

	AWARENESS	DISCOVERY	CONSIDERATION	BUY
		path is real — and it starts with knowing what your people can actually do.	Managers retain final judgment on every development decision.	

Theme 3: Workforce Intelligence & Agility

Primary persona: COO / Business Leader | Secondary: CHRO (Discovery), Resource Managers (Consideration), CIO / CTO (Buy)

About this theme

This theme is for business leaders who need to move faster than their people data allows — deploying the right capabilities to new initiatives, redeploying talent across teams, and making workforce decisions in real time rather than from stale reports. The core value is velocity and visibility: knowing who you have, what they can do, and how to move them now. Primary audience: COOs and Business Leaders; secondary: CHROs, Resource Managers, and CIOs/CTOs.

Products

Talent Intelligence Platform — three-layer intelligence foundation (Foundational, Enterprise, Domain) powering a real-time picture of workforce capability and potential across the entire organization

Resource Management — deploys the right people to the right work by matching capabilities to availability, expertise, and trajectory simultaneously

TalentForge — custom talent applications built on Eightfold's intelligence foundation, designed for your deployment architecture and workforce structure

	AWARENESS	DISCOVERY	CONSIDERATION	BUY
Stage Question	<i>The way we hire, develop, and deploy talent isn't keeping pace with the business — and I don't yet have a clear picture of why or what to do about it.</i>	<i>What does AI-powered talent intelligence actually do — and how is it fundamentally different from the HCM system we already have?</i>	<i>We understand the category. Now we need to know: does the evidence hold up — what do organizations like ours actually achieve, and how does Eightfold compare to what we already have?</i>	<i>We're ready to go deeper. We want to see Eightfold work for our specific situation before we move forward.</i>
Customer Lens <i>The question the prospect has</i>	We're making multi-million dollar workforce decisions on headcount projections and HR reports that are already outdated by the time we act on them. When a new initiative spins up, we don't know what capabilities already exist in other parts of the business — so we default to hiring, which takes months we don't have. How do we get a real-time picture of what our people can actually do — and move them fast enough to keep pace with the business?	What is talent intelligence, and how is it different from the workforce analytics our HCM already provides? What does it actually enable that we can't do today — for succession, redeployment, resource allocation, and strategic planning?	What outcomes have organizations achieved for workforce planning, succession, and resource deployment — and how does Eightfold compare to the workforce analytics or planning modules we already have from our HCM?	We want to see what Eightfold's intelligence reveals about our specific workforce — our capacity, our capability gaps, our deployment inefficiencies — before we take the next step.
Eightfold Lens <i>Our differentiated answer</i>	The business moves faster than the data. Traditional HCM was designed to store records, not act on them — so every redeployment decision starts from a blank page, and every new initiative defaults to headcount. Talent Intelligence gives you a dynamic, real-time picture of what your workforce can actually do: the capabilities sitting in teams you	Workforce analytics tells you what happened. Talent Intelligence tells you what's possible. Eightfold's intelligence works across three layers: Foundational Intelligence from large language models, Enterprise Intelligence from your own HR and business data, and Domain Intelligence from 1.6 billion career trajectories and 1.6 million skills. Most	Arcadis shifted to skills-based project deployment. Eaton closed its workforce capability gap. Resource Management matches capabilities to work based on availability, expertise, and trajectory — so the right person is in the right role before the project falls behind. HCM analytics surface what happened. Eightfold acts on what's	Request a workforce intelligence assessment. We'll show you what the platform detects in your existing data — capabilities your current systems have never surfaced, deployment gaps you can close today, and succession risks you can act on before they become headcount decisions.

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	haven't asked, the people who are ready for work that hasn't been posted yet. Your people data has been sitting in systems that know everything and do nothing. Velocity and visibility change what's possible.	vendors have one or two of these — Eightfold has all three. The difference between knowing you have a capability gap — and knowing who on your payroll can close it.	possible — for redeployment, succession, and capacity planning simultaneously.	The platform is ISO/IEC 42001 certified and connects to your existing HCM stack. A third of the Fortune 500 trust Eightfold.

Theme 4: AI You Can Trust

Primary persona: CHRO + CIO (governance and risk) | Secondary: TA Leaders (Consideration), CFO / Legal (Buy)

About this theme

This theme is for organizations that need to deploy AI in talent decisions but face regulatory, legal, and reputational risk. It covers Eightfold's compliance credentials — the first HR technology company certified across all three levels of ISO/IEC 42001:2023, with published bias audits and FedRAMP Moderate Authorization — and how these translate to defensible AI in hiring and workforce decisions. Primary audience: CHROs and CIOs focused on governance and risk; secondary: TA Leaders, CFOs, and Legal.

Products

AI Interviewer — bias audit results published by demographic group; candidate transparency and opt-out design built in

Talent Intelligence Platform — ISO/IEC 42001 certified across all three levels, FedRAMP Moderate Authorized, SOC 2 compliant; compliance-first architecture with Ethics Council oversight

Talent Acquisition — EEOC-ready hiring workflow with auditable, consistent evaluation across every candidate

Workforce Readiness — board-ready metric for tracking how AI adoption is actually progressing across the organization

TalentForge — custom compliance reporting, governance dashboards, and AI transparency tools built on Eightfold's certified intelligence foundation

	AWARENESS	DISCOVERY	CONSIDERATION	BUY
Stage Question	<i>The way we hire, develop, and deploy talent isn't keeping pace with the business — and I don't yet have a clear picture of why or what to do about it.</i>	<i>What does AI-powered talent intelligence actually do — and how is it fundamentally different from the HCM system we already have?</i>	<i>We understand the category. Now we need to know: does the evidence hold up — what do organizations like ours actually achieve, and how does Eightfold compare to what we already have?</i>	<i>We're ready to go deeper. We want to see Eightfold work for our specific situation before we move forward.</i>
Customer Lens <i>The question the prospect has</i>	Every HR vendor now claims AI. But AI in hiring creates real regulatory and reputational risk — bias claims, EU AI Act compliance, NY Local Law 144, and GDPR. Who actually has the credentials — not just the claims — to stand behind their AI?	What does ISO/IEC 42001 certification actually mean for our organization — and how does Eightfold's approach to bias reduction, data governance, and AI transparency hold up against the regulatory requirements we're facing?	We've assessed the regulatory landscape. Now we need to compare Eightfold's credentials against what other vendors claim — and understand what documentation is available for our Legal and Compliance teams to review.	We need to see the actual compliance documentation and understand how Eightfold's governance model works in practice — before Legal and Procurement get involved.
Eightfold Lens <i>Our differentiated answer</i>	Compliance trained. Bias removed. Not as a feature — as the foundation. Eightfold.ai is the first HR technology company certified across all three levels of ISO/IEC 42001:2023, the international AI management system standard. In a market where everyone claims responsible AI, we publish the evidence.	ISO/IEC 42001 is the first international standard for AI management systems — and Eightfold is certified across all three levels, the first in HR technology to achieve this. Our bias audits are published. Our AI Interviewer candidates are informed, not invisibly evaluated. Our compliance design is built for EEOC, GDPR, EU AI Act, and US state-level AI hiring laws — not retrofitted after the fact.	We publish our bias audit results by demographic group. We are the first HR technology organization certified across all three levels of ISO/IEC 42001:2023. Our FedRAMP Moderate Authorization covers federal and regulated industry procurement. Other vendors describe their AI as fair or ethical. We show you the methodology, the results, and the ongoing audit program that keeps the	Request the full compliance documentation package: bias audit methodology, per-demographic results, ISO 42001 certification evidence, FedRAMP authorization, and our AI transparency report. Responsible AI is not a launch checklist — it is an ongoing commitment. Eightfold continuously re-audits bias, updates compliance posture as regulations evolve, and publishes transparency reports. The

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			certification active — not awarded once.	ISO/IEC 42001 certification is maintained, not awarded once.

Theme 5: Public Sector Mission Readiness

Primary persona: Government Agency HR Director / Workforce Leader | Secondary: Agency CIO / IT Leader (Discovery + Buy), Program Managers (Consideration), OMB / Procurement (Buy)

About this theme

This theme is for government agencies facing workforce shortages, capability mismatches, and the need to modernize talent operations within civil service constraints. It covers how Workforce Exchange enables cross-agency talent sharing and skills-based redeployment at mission speed — without replacing existing federal HR systems. Primary audience: Government Agency HR Directors and Workforce Leaders; secondary: Agency CIOs, Program Managers, and OMB/Procurement.

Products

Workforce Exchange — the talent marketplace built for government: cross-agency skills-based redeployment and mission-critical workforce programs designed for civil service and OPM frameworks

Talent Intelligence Platform — FedRAMP Moderate Authorized intelligence foundation for real-time workforce visibility at agency scale

Resource Management — deploys the right people to the right mission work by matching capabilities to availability, expertise, and trajectory simultaneously

TalentForge — custom government talent applications tailored to agency mission, workforce structure, and civil service requirements in weeks, not quarters

	AWARENESS	DISCOVERY	CONSIDERATION	BUY
Stage Question	<i>The way we hire, develop, and deploy talent isn't keeping pace with the mission — and traditional civil service systems weren't designed for the speed or complexity we're facing now.</i>	<i>What does AI-powered talent intelligence actually do for a government agency — and how is it different from the HRIS and workforce systems we already have?</i>	<i>We understand the category. Now we need to know: what have other government agencies and large enterprises actually achieved — and does Eightfold meet our security and procurement requirements?</i>	<i>We're ready to go deeper. We want to see how Eightfold works within our agency's actual workforce structure, security environment, and procurement pathways before we move forward.</i>
Customer Lens <i>The question the prospect has</i>	Our agency faces workforce shortages, aging talent, and capability mismatches — and we're trying to modernize with the agility the private sector takes for granted, but within civil service rules, union agreements, and procurement constraints. We're redeploying talent manually, losing institutional knowledge to retirements, and hiring too slowly. Who is actually helping government agencies transform?	What does AI-powered talent intelligence mean for a government agency — and can it work within our IT security requirements, OPM frameworks, and civil service rules? How is Workforce Exchange different from our existing workforce management systems, and what does implementation actually look like in a government context?	What have other agencies and large public-sector employers achieved — specifically for workforce redeployment, cross-agency talent sharing, and skills-based hiring? How does Eightfold compare to our current HRIS and workforce planning systems, and does it have the certifications we need for federal IT procurement?	We need to understand how Eightfold works within our procurement process, our IT security requirements, and our specific agency workforce structure before we move forward. What does the compliance documentation look like, and how do we get started?
Eightfold Lens <i>Our differentiated answer</i>	Government agencies aren't talent-poor — they're talent-blind. The capabilities your workforce has and the mission work you need to get done are both visible to Eightfold — even when your HRIS can't see either. Workforce Exchange was built specifically for the public sector: connecting agencies to talent they	Workforce Exchange is not a job board — it's a talent marketplace that matches the capabilities your people actually have to the work your agency needs to get done, across team boundaries, across programs, and across agencies. Where the private	The Department of Defense deployed talent intelligence at enterprise scale. Arcadis shifted to skills-based project deployment. Workforce Exchange enables agencies to redeploy talent faster than a new hire cycle — critical when mission requirements shift faster than headcount approvals.	Request a workforce capabilities assessment for your agency. We'll show you what Eightfold's intelligence detects in your existing workforce data — capability gaps, redeployment opportunities, and mission-readiness risks you can act on before they become headcount requests.

	AWARENESS	DISCOVERY	CONSIDERATION	BUY
	already have, identifying the capabilities the mission needs next, and making redeployment faster than a new hire cycle. The Department of Defense deployed Eightfold at enterprise scale. A third of the Fortune 500 trust Eightfold — and so does the government.	sector calls it internal mobility, the government calls it mission readiness. The Eightfold Platform is FedRAMP Moderate Authorized, built for government security requirements, and integrates with existing federal HR systems.	Eightfold's FedRAMP Moderate Authorization and ISO/IEC 42001 certification satisfy federal IT procurement requirements. Skills-based deployment means the right person is in the right program before the work falls behind schedule or over budget.	The platform is FedRAMP Moderate Authorized, ISO/IEC 42001 certified, and built for government procurement pathways. TalentForge enables your agency to build custom talent applications on Eightfold's intelligence foundation — tailored to your mission, your org structure, and your civil service requirements — in weeks, not quarters.